

Subject Code	ENGL4007			
Subject Title	Multimodal Analysis of Advertisements			
Credit Value	3			
Level	4			
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None			
Objectives	The subject aims to help students to develop an understanding of various theoretical approaches and methods relating to visual image analysis and the relation between advertising and society. It aims to develop students' critical advertisement reading skills, and their ability to broaden and extend the application of multimodal analysis in print, television, and new media advertising for effective professional communication.			
Intended Learning Outcome	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - recognize the key role of images in print advertisements as well as television and new media advertising; - discuss the significance of advertising in contemporary society; - apply multimodal theories to analyze various forms of advertising; - use different modes of advertising, especially visual images, effectively in professional communication; - exercise judgment and develop intellectual curiosity; - engage with English professional interaction in a more considered and responsible way and employ a range of strategies for learning autonomously and collaboratively.			
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus/ Indicative Syllabus	- The design of modern advertising with reference to: - multimodal theories (e.g. multimodal metaphor, visual grammar, appraisal) in two-dimensional hard copy advertisements, television commercials, and new forms of new media advertising - the integrated use of multiple modes in commercials - The functions of multi-modes in promotional communication; - The relationships between advertising and society.			
Teaching/ Learning Methodology	The subject will be conducted in interactive lectures. The assignments will involve student-led seminars, a mid-term quiz and a final paper. Students are expected to study and evaluate a range of print, television, and new media advertising examples in relation to multimodal features throughout the course. Each assessment activity requires multimodal discourse knowledge and analytical skills.			
Assessment Methods in Alignment with	Specific Assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)	

Intended Learning Outcomes			a	b	c	d	e	f
	1. Student-led seminars	25%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	2. Mid-term quiz	20%	✓	✓	✓			✓
	3. Final Paper	40%	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓
	4. Class Participation	15%		✓	✓		✓	✓
	Total	100%						
	1. The student-led seminars are designed for students to take up their own learning responsibility through researching on examples of advertisements and discussing and presenting them with the rest of the group members in class. 2. The mid-term quiz measures students’ comprehension of the course concepts. 3. The final paper evaluates students’ understanding of the analytical tools and theoretical frameworks, using authentic commercial texts to reflect real-world practice. 4. Class participation assesses students’ engagement and understanding of course concepts, encouraging them to actively apply analytical tools and engage with discussions in a collaborative learning environment.							
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	● Lectures					39 Hrs.		
	Other student study effort:							
	● Preparation for assignments					30 Hrs.		
	● Research and private study					57 Hrs.		
	Total student study effort					126 Hrs.		
Reading List and References	Arnheim, R. (1988). <i>The power of the center: A study of composition in the visual arts</i> (New version.). University of California Press. Crystal, D. (1998). Towards a typographical linguistics. <i>Type</i>, 2(1), 7-23. Forceville, C. (1996). <i>Pictorial metaphors in advertising</i>. Routledge. Gage, J. (1993). <i>Colour and culture: Practice and meaning from antiquity to abstraction</i>. Thames and Hudson.							

	Gage, J. (1999). <i>Colour and meaning: Art, science and symbolism</i>. Thames and Hudson. Goodman, S. & Graddol, D. (1996). <i>Redesigning English: New texts, new identities</i>. Routledge. Chapter 2 (esp pp. 73-81) Kress, G. R., & Van Leeuwen, T. (2021). <i>Reading images: The grammar of visual design</i> (3rd edition.). Routledge. Leeuwen, T. (2001). <i>Multimodal discourse analysis: The modes and media of contemporary communication</i>. Arnold. (esp ch 1 and 4) Kress, G., & Van Leeuwen, T. (2002). Colour as a semiotic mode: Notes towards a grammar of colour. <i>Visual Communication</i>, 1(3), 343-369. Martin, J.R., & White, P.P.R. (2005). <i>The language of evaluation</i>. Palgrave. Nowacek, N. (2005). Character to character. <i>Visual Communication</i>, 4(2), 158-165. Van Leeuwen, T. (2005). <i>Introducing social semiotics</i>. Routledge. (esp. ch 1, 6, 10) Van Leeuwen, T. (2005). Multimodality, genre and design. In Sigrid Norris and Rodney Jones (eds.), <i>Discourse in action: Introducing Mediated Discourse Analysis</i>. Routledge. Van Leeuwen, T. (2006). Towards a semiotics of typography. <i>Information Design Journal</i>, 14(2), 139-155.
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Revised by Amy Suen, May 2026